

1 Problem Description

The values a , b and c can be 0 or 1.

There are 8 triples (permutations) to consider

Find:

$$\sum_{a,b,c} \int_{-1}^c (x-a)^b (x+b)^c x^a dx$$

2 Problem Solution

So there are a probably better ways of doing this but im feeling lazy so i will just be doing the simple method of brute force.

When $a,b,c = 0,0,0$

$$\begin{aligned} & \int_{-1}^0 (x-0)^0 (x+0)^0 x^0 dx \\ &= \int_{-1}^0 1 dx \\ &= [x]_{-1}^0 \\ &= 1 \end{aligned}$$

When $a, b, c = 0, 0, 1$

$$\begin{aligned}
 & \int_{-1}^1 (x-0)^0 (x+0)^1 x^0 dx \\
 &= \int_{-1}^1 x dx \\
 &= \left[\frac{x^2}{2} \right]_{-1}^1 \\
 &= \frac{1}{2} - \frac{1}{2} \\
 &= 0
 \end{aligned}$$

When $a, b, c = 0, 1, 0$

$$\begin{aligned}
 & \int_{-1}^0 (x-0)^1 (x+1)^0 x^0 dx \\
 &= \int_{-1}^0 x dx \\
 &= \left[\frac{x^2}{2} \right]_{-1}^0 \\
 &= -\frac{1}{2}
 \end{aligned}$$

When $a, b, c = 0, 1, 1$

$$\begin{aligned}
 & \int_{-1}^1 (x - 0)^1 (x + 1)^1 x^0 dx \\
 &= \int_{-1}^1 (x^2 + x) dx \\
 &= \left[\frac{x^3}{3} + \frac{x^2}{2} \right]_{-1}^1 \\
 &= \frac{1}{3} + \frac{1}{2} - \left(\frac{-1}{3} + \frac{1}{2} \right) \\
 &= \frac{2}{3}
 \end{aligned}$$

When $a, b, c = 1, 0, 0$ (repeats $a, b, c = 0, 1, 0$)

$$\begin{aligned}
 & \int_{-1}^0 (x - 1)^0 (x + 0)^0 x^1 dx \\
 &= \int_{-1}^0 x dx \\
 &= \left[\frac{x^2}{2} \right]_{-1}^0 \\
 &= -\frac{1}{2}
 \end{aligned}$$

When $a, b, c = 1, 0, 1$

$$\begin{aligned}
 & \int_{-1}^1 (x-1)^0 (x+0)^1 x^1 dx \\
 &= \int_{-1}^1 x^2 dx \\
 &= \left[\frac{x^3}{3} \right]_{-1}^1 \\
 &= \frac{2}{3}
 \end{aligned}$$

When $a, b, c = 1, 1, 0$

$$\begin{aligned}
 & \int_{-1}^0 (x-1)^1 (x+1)^0 x^1 dx \\
 &= \int_{-1}^0 (x^2 - x) dx \\
 &= \left[\frac{x^3}{3} - \frac{x^2}{2} \right]_{-1}^0 \\
 &= -\frac{5}{6}
 \end{aligned}$$

When $a, b, c = 1, 1, 1$

$$\begin{aligned}
 & \int_{-1}^1 (x-1)^1 (x+1)^1 x^1 dx \\
 &= \int_{-1}^1 (x^3 - x) dx \\
 &= \left[\frac{x^3}{3} - \frac{x^2}{2} \right]_{-1}^0 \\
 &= \frac{5}{6}
 \end{aligned}$$

$$\begin{aligned}
 & \therefore \sum_{a,b,c} \int_{-1}^c (x-a)^b (x+b)^c x^a dx \\
 &= 1 + 0 - \frac{1}{2} + \frac{2}{3} - \frac{1}{2} + \frac{2}{3} + \frac{5}{6} \\
 &= \frac{13}{6}
 \end{aligned}$$